

Commodities Sentiment Report

2026-07-07 11:10 UTC

Previous edition: 2026-07-06 23:00 UTC. First edition in the RV-desk format: crowdedness scores (0-3), pair matrix with sentiment differentials, dated catalyst calendar, and positioning reads per leg.

COMMODITY	SENTIMENT	CROWD	Δ VS LAST	ONE-LINE DRIVER
Crude Oil (WTI/Brent)	-1 Leaning bearish	○○○ 0	unchanged	OPEC+ quota hike + \$11 Aramco OSP cut vs LNG carrier struck near Hormuz
Natural Gas	-2 Bearish	○○○ 0	unchanged	Storage surplus + cool forecasts; crowd still leans bullish against the news
Gold	+1 Leaning bullish	●○○ 1	unchanged	Holding pattern into Wednesday's Fed minutes; labor-market tailwind intact
Silver	+2 Bullish	●●● 3	unchanged	Holding the rebound (~\$62.75); most crowded bullish view on the board
Copper	+1 Leaning bullish	●○○ 1	unchanged	Narrow range; Fed repricing + China fund rotation, awaiting hard demand data
Wheat	+2 Bullish	●○○ 1	unchanged	Structural supply story vs managed money extremely short and Sell technicals
Corn	+2 Bullish	●○○ 1	unchanged	Holding one-month high on France damage + China framework
Soybeans	+1 Leaning bullish	○○○ 0	▲ from Neutral	Cofco booked 6+ US cargoes; five-week high \$11.80 — the China tell triggered

Direction: -3 Very bearish → +3 Very bullish. Crowd: 0 two-sided → 3 crowded & uniform (contrarian risk). Sentiment reflects the tone of current news and trader coverage about the price outlook, not the last price move.

BIGGEST SHIFTS

Soybeans upgraded to Leaning bullish (+1) — the exact trigger flagged in prior editions fired: China's Cofco booked at least six cargoes of US soybeans for Sep-Oct shipment (on top of ~200kt already bought), under the summit agreement covering ≥25M tons annually through 2028, and beans hit a five-week high near \$11.80. That narrows the corn-soybean sentiment spread from +2 to +1. Crude is now genuinely two-sided (crowd 0): OPEC+ raised quotas and Aramco cut its Arab Light OSP by \$11 for Asia — aggressive supply-side bearishness — but a Qatari LNG carrier was struck by a projectile near Hormuz, reviving the war-risk bid and pushing WTI to a one-week high above \$69. Watch that tension resolve.

RV pair matrix

Sentiment spread = leg1 – leg2; positive favors leg1 outperformance.

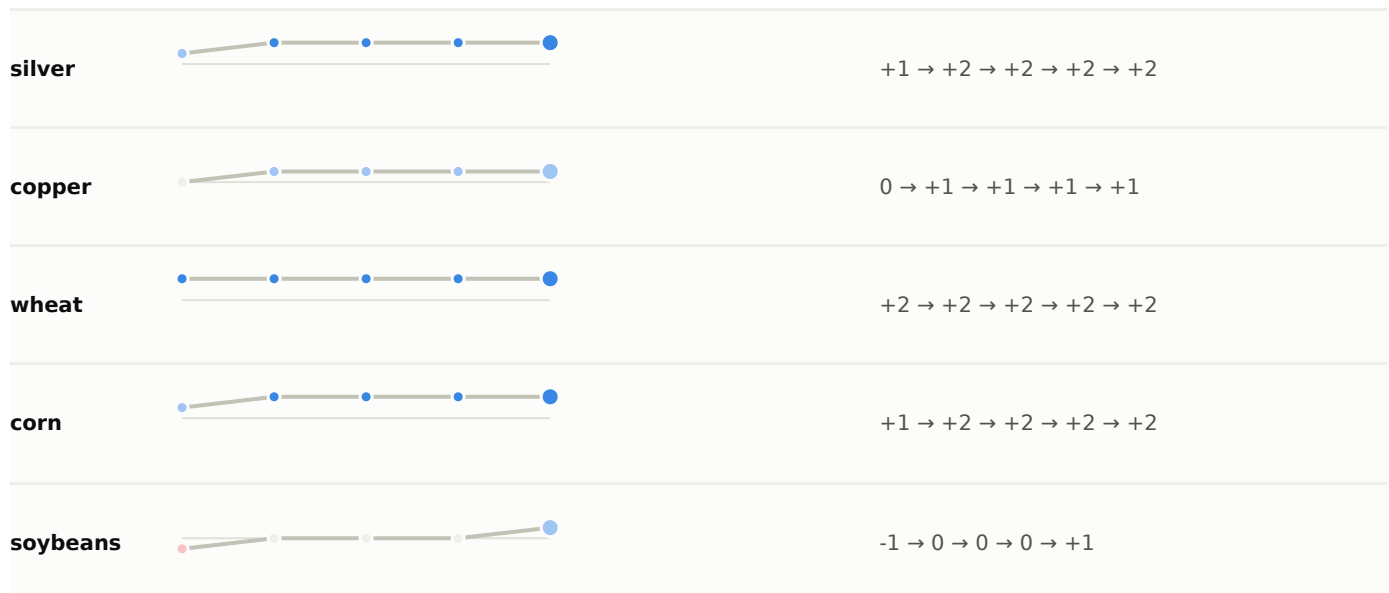
PAIR	SPREAD	Δ VS LAST	READ
gold – silver	-1	unchanged	News flow still favors silver beta, but silver is crowd-3 vs gold's crowd-1 — the differential is increasingly a positioning risk, not a fresh signal
corn – soybeans	+1	▼ from +2	Narrowing. Beans leg upgraded on real China cargoes; corn's edge now rests on France damage + US pollination weather alone
corn – wheat	0	unchanged	Both +2 but different engines: corn = demand + weather, wheat = structural supply. Wheat has the short-covering kicker if COT confirms
crude – natgas	+1	unchanged	Both bearish complexes; crude has the two-sided geopolitical tail (Hormuz), gas has the priced-in argument. Spread is a war-risk expression
gold – copper	0	unchanged	Same macro driver (Fed repricing) lifting both; no divergent signal until China data or Fed minutes split them

Catalyst calendar (next 7 days)

DATE	EVENT	LEGS	WHY IT MATTERS NOW
Tue Jul 7	API petroleum inventories (4:30pm ET)	crude	First read on whether the surplus narrative shows up in stocks
Wed Jul 8	FOMC minutes (2pm ET)	gold, silver, copper	The metals' entire tailwind is the ~50% Sept hike repricing; hawkish minutes hit crowd-3 silver hardest
Wed Jul 8	EIA Weekly Petroleum Status (10:30am ET)	crude	Confirms/denies API; a draw would strengthen the floor at \$68-70
Thu Jul 9	EIA natural gas storage (10:30am ET)	natural-gas	Another >90 Bcf injection entrenches -2; a miss feeds the crowd's snap-back thesis
Thu Jul 9	USDA weekly export sales (8:30am ET)	wheat, corn, soybeans	The print for the beans upgrade — Cofco cargoes should start showing in the data
Fri Jul 10	CFTC COT (3:30pm ET)	all	Wheat is the one to check: are extreme managed-money shorts starting to cover?
Fri Jul 10	Baker Hughes rig count (1pm ET)	crude, natural-gas	Supply-side confirmation for both energy legs
Jul 10-12 window	USDA WASDE (date per USDA calendar)	wheat, corn, soybeans	First full balance-sheet update since the acreage shocks; verify exact date
Mon Jul 13	USDA Crop Progress (4pm ET)	corn, soybeans	Pollination-window condition scores — corn's weather premium lives or dies here

Score history (oldest → newest)

crude-oil		-2 → -1 → -1 → -1 → -1
natural-gas		-1 → -1 → -1 → -2 → -2
gold		+1 → +1 → +1 → +1 → +1



Crude Oil (WTI / Brent) -1 Leaning bearish ○○○ 0

What's happening. The bear case escalated: OPEC+ agreed over the weekend to raise production quotas for next month, and Saudi Aramco cut its Arab Light OSP for Asia by \$11/bbl to \$1.50 *below* the regional benchmark — but a fully laden Qatari LNG carrier was struck by a projectile near the Omani coast exiting Hormuz, reviving doubts about the US-Iran agreement's durability and lifting WTI to a one-week high above \$69 ([Trading Economics](#), [OilPrice](#), [Fortune](#)).

Social pulse. Bearish-but-buying-support: TradingView chatter still leans sell with retail bids clustered at \$68-70 and stops below ([TradingView Minds](#)); some chatter now argues supply risks are again bigger than demand fears.

Positioning read. This is now a two-sided market (crowd 0) — shorts face headline risk from every Hormuz incident, longs face OPEC+ barrels and an OSP that screams weak Asian demand. The asymmetry: the supply bearishness is scheduled and priced, the geopolitical risk is not. Flat-price shorts should be smaller; the cleaner expression is relative (e.g. vs gas, or curve structure if the OSP cut drags spot). Wednesday's EIA is the next dated test.

Natural Gas -2 Bearish ○○○ 0

What's happening. Henry Hub steadied around \$3.22-3.29 but the news basis is unchanged and bearish: storage 6.2% above average after the 87 Bcf build, production near record ~110 Bcf/d, and cooler July 7-16 forecasts ([Trading Economics](#), [Investing.com](#)). The Hormuz LNG-carrier strike is a global gas story — it supports TTF/JKM and, at the margin, US LNG export demand (feedgas already ~17.3 Bcf/d).

Social pulse. *Still diverges bullish:* polls ~55-60% bullish on the "bearish news is priced in near multi-year lows" thesis ([TradingView](#)).

Positioning read. News says -2, crowd says fade it — which caps the risk/reward of fresh shorts down here. The LNG-security angle is the underpriced tail: if Hormuz incidents continue, global gas premiums pull US feedgas demand up while Henry Hub is priced for weather-driven softness. Thursday's EIA injection is the dated catalyst; a sub-consensus print plus any LNG headline flips this fast.

Gold +1 Leaning bullish ●○○ 1

What's happening. Gold consolidates around \$4,140-4,166 after the dollar-driven pullback from two-week highs; the weak-payrolls repricing (Sept hike odds ~50%) still underpins, with Wednesday's FOMC minutes the gate ([Trading Economics](#), [Kitco](#)).

Social pulse. Mixed-to-bullish; miner enthusiasm remains the hot spot while the metal itself has visible two-way chatter ([TradingView Minds](#)).

Positioning read. Gold is the lower-crowd way to hold the Fed-repricing view (crowd 1 vs silver's 3). Into the minutes, that's the trade-structure takeaway: if you want the dovish outcome, gold gives it with less crowd unwind risk; if the minutes read hawkish, gold should outperform silver on the way down (long gold/short silver as the hedge expression).

Silver +2 Bullish ●●● 3

What's happening. Silver holds ~\$62.75 after the ~6% rebound off seven-month lows; safe-haven demand, the Warsh cooling-inflation comments and soft hiring data remain the cited drivers ([Kitco](#), [Trading Economics](#)).

Social pulse. Uniformly bullish — retail accumulating dips, SLV gauge bullish while GLD sits bearish ([StockTwits SLV](#)). No meaningful bear case circulating: that uniformity is the crowd-3.

Positioning read. Direction +2, but this is the board's most crowded view, one macro print from an air pocket. Longs should be sized for a hawkish-minutes gap; the gold/silver ratio is the release valve (silver underperforms both directions of a shakeout). Fresh entries here are buying what the crowd already owns — wait for the minutes or buy the ratio dip.

Copper +1 Leaning bullish ●○○ 1

What's happening. Copper trades a narrow \$6.15-6.25 range: Fed repricing supportive, Chinese funds rotating into metals ahead of H1 producer earnings, South American concentrate output dented — but no hard China demand print yet ([Trading Economics](#), [Investing.com](#)).

Social pulse. Constructive; bank bull targets (Citi ~\$14,500/t) still the most-shared item ([TradingView news](#)), with some caution on "premium levels" fading.

Positioning read. Copper is the un-crowded cyclical leg of the metals repricing — same macro driver as silver at crowd 1 instead of 3. China industrial data and mid-month trade numbers are the dated catalysts that would move it to +2; the Fed minutes are the shared risk with the precious legs (gold–copper spread stays 0 until one of those splits them).

Wheat +2 Bullish ●○○ 1

What's happening. Wheat consolidated (-0.7% to ~\$6.02 after the surge) but the structural story keeps hardening: plantings 42.74M acres — lowest in USDA records back to 1919 — HRW crop smallest since 1957/58, June stocks below expectations; Black Sea production still caps the global balance ([Trading Economics](#), [USDA ERS](#)).

Social pulse. The mood/money split sharpened: chatter now describes managed money *extremely* short with commercials aggressively long, while technical readings still lean Sell ([TradingView wheat forums](#)).

Positioning read. This is the board's clearest asymmetry: a strengthening supply narrative sitting on top of an extreme short base. If Friday's COT shows covering has begun, the squeeze can run well past fundamentals; the invalidator is aggressive Black Sea export offers undercutting US futures. Corn–wheat at 0 understates wheat's kicker — the spread expression is long wheat vs corn into the COT print if you want the squeeze without the outright weather risk.

Corn +2 Bullish ●○○ 1

What's happening. Corn holds its one-month high (~\$4.27-4.30): France heat damage (~1/3 of crop), below-forecast US stocks (5.295B bu) and acreage (95.34M), and the US-China reciprocal tariff framework covering ag ([Trading Economics](#), [AgWeb](#)).

Social pulse. Still lagging the headlines; cautious sideways framing dominates dated chatter ([TradingView corn ideas](#)). No contradicting signal.

Positioning read. Corn's +2 now leans harder on weather than it did yesterday — the China catalyst migrated to the beans leg (Cofco is booking beans, not corn, so far). Monday's Crop Progress and the mid-July pollination forecasts are the dated risk; the corn–soybean spread (+1 and narrowing) is the cleaner way to fade corn's weather premium if forecasts turn benign.

Soybeans +1 Leaning bullish ○○○ 0

What's happening. *Upgraded.* Beans hit a five-week high near \$11.80: Cofco booked at least six US cargoes for Sep-Oct on top of ~200kt already bought, under the summit deal targeting ≥25M tons annually through 2028; above-normal mid-July temperatures add a weather kicker against improving rain prospects ([Trading Economics](#), [Barchart](#)).

Social pulse. No fresh social signal — chatter hasn't caught up to the Cofco bookings ([TradingView soybean ideas](#)).

Positioning read. The demand leg the bear case rested on just showed up, and the crowd hasn't repriced it (crowd 0) — that's the freshest signal on the board. Thursday's export sales print is the dated confirmation; if the cargoes register and more follow, the corn–soybean spread keeps compressing and the outright can retest the big-stocks ceiling. Invalidator: bookings stall at token volumes while US weather turns benign.